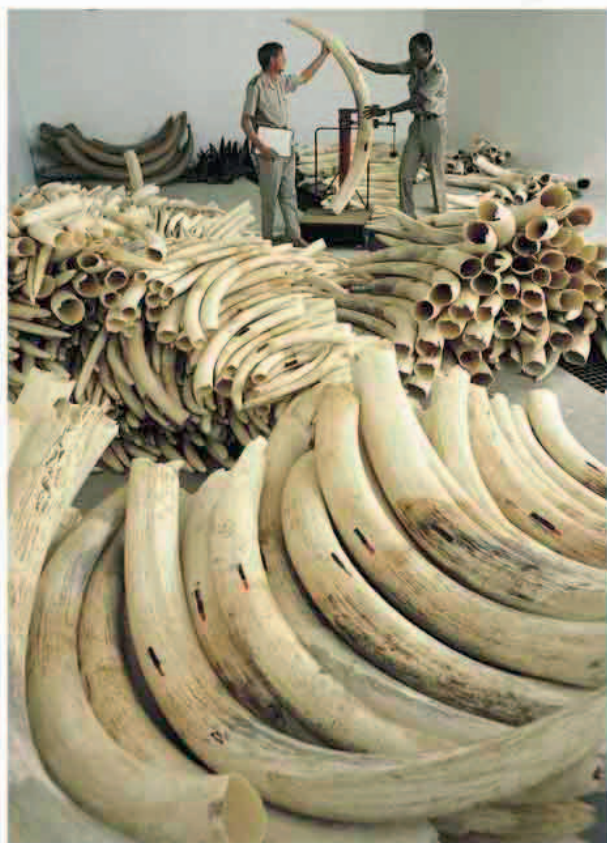


Conservation

The future of the world depends on maintaining a healthy biosphere—the web of life that produces our food and makes the air fit to breathe. We can help keep it healthy by protecting threatened species and the wild places where they live. In the process, we also help maintain the beauty of the natural world.

PROTECTED SPECIES

The simplest form of conservation is to protect certain species by making it illegal to kill them. Such bans have to be global in order to work, and international treaties have helped in the case of animals such as elephants and whales. As long as these laws are enforced, they can help endangered species recover from near extinction.



▲ **THREATENED CAT**
Rare animals such as tigers are protected by laws that make hunting them a criminal offense.

ILLEGAL TRADE

There are laws banning the trade in endangered species and goods such as ivory, rhino horns, and tiger skins. But demand for illegal goods remains, encouraging poachers to break the laws. Wildlife rangers often have to cope with armed poachers and carry out raids to confiscate illegal materials.

◀ **BLACK-MARKET IVORY**
Conservation officers inspect a huge haul of illegal elephant tusks recovered from a rogue trader.